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United States Patent	12396758
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 26, 2025
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Polyaxial bone fixation element

Abstract

A fastener device includes an anchor body that defines a through hole. The anchor body further includes an inner surface that defines a least a portion of the through hole. The fastener includes a head, a threaded shaft that extends out with respect to the head in a distal direction, and a neck between the head and threaded shaft. The head includes an outer surface configured to articulate along the inner surface when the fastener head is inserted in the through hole. At least a portion of the outer surface is convex and defines a portion of a sphere that defines a first diameter. The neck defines a second diameter and the fastener defines a ratio of the first diameter to the second diameter in a range between about 2 to 1 and about 3 to 1.

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Appl. No.: 18/062605

Filed: December 07, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230102605 A1	Mar. 30, 2023

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 16871085 20200511 US 11547449 child-doc US 18062605
continuation parent-doc US 15441326 20170224 US 10675061 20200609 child-doc US 16871085
us-provisional-application US 62300456 20160226

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: A61B17/70 (20060101); A61B17/86 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC A61B17/7001 (20130101); A61B17/7037 (20130101); A61B17/7038 (20130101);
A61B17/8605 (20130101); A61B17/8685 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: A61B (17/7032); A61B (17/7034); A61B (17/7035); A61B (17/7037); A61B (17/7038);
A61B (17/861); A61B (17/862); A61B (2017/8655)

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/871,085 filed May 11, 2020, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/441,326 filed Feb. 24, 2017, which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/300,456, filed Feb. 26, 2016, the contents of each of which are hereby incorporated by reference as if set forth in their entirety herein.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present application relates generally to medical devices. More specifically, the present application is related to devices, kits, and methods for treatment of a spine.

BACKGROUND

(2) Various spinal disorders may be surgically corrected to stabilize a patient's spinal column. Spinal disorders may include curvatures or other defects that are correctable with a spinal fusion procedure. One method of spinal fusion involves one or more elongated members, typically spinal rods, longitudinally placed on the posterior spine. When a pair of elongated members is used in the spinal fusion procedure, the elongated members may be placed on either side of spinous processes of the vertebral column, for example.

(3) Each elongated member may be attached to one or more of the vertebrae of the spine by way of fastener devices. The fastener devices each may include an anchor body defining a rod-receiving channel configured to receive a portion of the elongated member therein, and a locking cap configured to clamp and secure the position of the elongated member within the rod-receiving channel. The fastener devices each may further include a fastener configured to secure the anchor body to a vertebra.

(4) To facilitate insertion of the elongated members into the rod-receiving channels and to provide additional flexibility in the positioning of the elongated members and the fastener devices, fastener devices have been developed wherein the anchor body is pivotable with respect to the fastener. These fastener devices may be referred to as polyaxial fastener devices.

(5) It is desirable to develop a fastener device that is simple for a surgeon to use, that provides for polyaxial rotation and is able to securely mount the elongated member to a patient's spine.

SUMMARY

(6) In accordance with an aspect of the disclosure, the present application discloses a fastener device comprising an anchor body and a fastener. The anchor body including an anchor body housing, the anchor body defining a through hole that extends through the anchor body housing, the anchor body further including an upper end, a lower end, and an inner surface, and the inner surface defining a least a portion of the through hole. The fastener including a head, a threaded shaft that extends out with respect to the head in a distal direction, and a neck that extends between the head and the threaded shaft. The head including an outer surface configured to articulate along the inner surface when the fastener head is inserted in the through hole, at least a portion of the outer surface being convex and defining a portion of a sphere, the sphere defining a first outer diameter, and the fastener including a concave surface that extends along both the head and the

neck, the neck defining a second outer diameter measured: 1) in a direction perpendicular to the distal direction, and 2) at a location spaced in the distal direction of an entirety of the concave surface, wherein the screw defines a ratio of the first outer diameter to the second outer diameter in a range between about 2 to 1 and about 3 to 1.

(7) In accordance with an aspect of the disclosure, the present application discloses a fastener device comprising an anchor body and a fastener. The anchor body including an anchor body housing, the anchor body defining a through hole that extends through the anchor body housing, the anchor body further including an upper end, a lower end, and an inner surface that defines a least a portion of the through hole, and at least a portion of the inner surface defining a portion of a first sphere. The fastener including a head, a threaded shaft that extends out with respect to the head in a distal direction, and a neck that extends between the head and the threaded shaft. The head including an outer surface, at least a portion of the outer surface defining a portion of a second sphere, and the head further including a concave surface of the fastener that extends along both the head and the neck. The fastener device defines a configuration in which both: 1) the portion of the outer surface rides along the portion of the inner surface, and 2) the anchor body abuts the neck at a location that is spaced in the distal direction from an entirety of the concave surface such that movement of the fastener relative to the anchor body in at least one direction is blocked.

(8) In accordance with an aspect of the disclosure, the present application discloses a fastener device comprising an anchor body and a fastener. The anchor body including an anchor body housing, the anchor body defining a through hole that extends through the anchor body housing, the anchor body further including an upper end, a lower end, and an inner surface, and the inner surface defining at least a portion of the through hole. The fastener including a head, a threaded shaft that extends out with respect to the head in a distal direction, and a neck that extends between the head and the threaded shaft. The head including a convex outer surface, a portion of the convex surface both defining a portion of a sphere and being configured to articulate along the inner surface when the fastener head is positioned in the through hole, and the fastener including a concave surface that extends along both the head and the neck. Wherein the fastener is configured such that all lines that: 1) lie entirely within a plane parallel to the distal direction, and 2) are tangent to the portion of the convex outer surface are noncollinear with all lines that: 1) lie entirely within the plane, and 2) are tangent to the concave surface.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The foregoing summary, as well as the following detailed description of illustrative embodiments of the application, will be better understood when read in conjunction with the appended drawings. For the purposes of illustrating the present disclosure, there is shown in the drawings illustrative embodiments. It should be understood, however, that the application is not limited to the specific embodiments and methods disclosed, and reference is made to the claims for that purpose. In the drawings:

(2) FIG. 1 is an isometric view of a fastener device, according to an aspect of the disclosure;

(3) FIG. 2 is an exploded isometric view of the fastener device illustrated in FIG. 1;

(4) FIG. 3 is a top plan view of a fastener of the fastener device illustrated in FIG. 1;

(5) FIG. 4 is a side elevation view of the fastener illustrated in FIG. 3;

(6) FIG. 5 is a cross-sectional view of the fastener illustrated in FIG. 3, along line 5-5;

(7) FIG. 6 is a top plan view of an anchor body of the fastener device illustrated in FIG. 1;

(8) FIG. 7 is a cross-sectional view of the anchor body illustrated in FIG. 6, along line 7-7;

(9) FIG. 8 is a cross-sectional view of the fastener device illustrated in FIG. 1, along line 8-8, the fastener device in a first configuration;

- (10) FIG. 9 is a cross-sectional view of the fastener device illustrated in FIG. 1, along line 8-8, the fastener device in a second configuration;
- (11) FIG. 10 is a cross-sectional view of the fastener device illustrated in FIG. 1, along line 8-8, the fastener device in a third configuration;
- (12) FIG. 11 is a cross-sectional view of the fastener device illustrated in FIG. 1, along line 8-8, the fastener device in the second configuration;
- (13) FIG. 12 is an exploded isometric view of a fastener device according to an aspect of the disclosure, the fastener device including a biasing member and an anchor body;
- (14) FIG. 13 is a top plan view of the biasing member illustrated in FIG. 12;
- (15) FIG. 14 is a cross-sectional view of the anchor body illustrated in FIG. 12, along line 14-14;
- (16) FIG. 15 is a cross-sectional view of the biasing member and the anchor body illustrated in FIG. 12, along line 14-14, the biasing member and the anchor body in an assembled configuration;
- (17) FIG. 16 is a cross-sectional view of the fastener device illustrated in FIG. 12, along line 14-14, the fastener device in a first configuration; and
- (18) FIG. 17 is a cross-sectional view of the fastener device illustrated in FIG. 12, along line 14-14, the fastener device in a second configuration.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (19) Certain terminology is used in the following description for convenience only and is not limiting. The words “lower” and “upper” designate directions in the drawings to which reference is made. The words “proximally” and “distally” refer to directions toward and away from, respectively, the surgeon using the medical device. The words, “anterior”, “posterior”, “superior”, “inferior” and related words and/or phrases designate preferred positions and orientations in the human body to which reference is made and are not meant to be limiting. The terminology includes the above-listed words, derivatives thereof and words of similar import.
- (20) Aspects of the disclosure will now be described in detail with reference to the drawings, wherein like reference numbers refer to like elements throughout, unless specified otherwise. Certain terminology is used in the following description for convenience only and is not limiting. The term “plurality”, as used herein, means more than one. The terms “a portion” and “at least a portion” of a structure include the entirety of the structure. Certain features of the disclosure which are described herein in the context of separate embodiments may also be provided in combination in a single embodiment. Conversely, various features of the disclosure that are described in the context of a single embodiment may also be provided separately or in any subcombination.
- (21) Reference herein to a first structure articulating along or riding along a second structure refers to the first structure directly contacting the second structure, and precludes an intermediate structure or surface between the first structure and the second structure.
- (22) Referring to FIGS. 1 and 2 a medical device 10 is configured to secure an elongated member to a portion of a patient's anatomy. As shown in the illustrated embodiment, the medical device 10 can include a fastener device 12 configured to secure a spinal rod 14 to a patient's vertebra, for example a pedicle or lateral mass of the patient's vertebra. The fastener device 12 may be referred to as a pedicle screw when the fastener device 12 is configured to secure the spinal rod 14 to the pedicle of the patient's vertebra. According to one aspect of the disclosure, the fastener device 12 includes an anchor body 16 configured to receive the spinal rod 14, and a fastener 18 configured to be inserted into the anchor body 16 and secured to the patient's vertebra.
- (23) The fastener device 12 may further include a saddle 20 and a cap 22. As shown in the illustrated embodiment the saddle 20 is configured to abut both the fastener 18 and the spinal rod 14, and the cap 22 is configured to secure the spinal rod 14 relative to the fastener device 12, as described in further detail below.
- (24) According to one aspect of the disclosure, the anchor body 16 includes an upper end 24, a lower end 26 spaced from the upper end 24 in a longitudinal direction L, and an anchor body housing 28 that extends from the upper end 24 to the lower end 26. The anchor body 16 defines a

through hole **30** that extends through the anchor body housing **28**. The fastener **18** includes a head **32**, a threaded shaft **34** that extends out with respect to the head **32** in a distal direction D, and a neck **36** that extends between the head **32** and the threaded shaft **34**. The fastener **18** is configured to be positioned into the anchor body **16** by moving the fastener **18** in the longitudinal direction L, until the threaded shaft **34** passes through the lower end **26** and the head **32** is positioned within the through hole **30**.

(25) The fastener device **12** is configured such that when the head **32** is positioned in the through hole **30** the fastener **18** is movable, polyaxially, with respect to the anchor body **16**. When the head **32** is positioned in the through hole **30**, the saddle **20** can be moved in the longitudinal direction L, until the saddle **20** contacts the head **32**. When the saddle **20** is contacting the head **32**, the spinal rod **14** can then be moved in the longitudinal direction L until the spinal rod **14** contacts the saddle **20**. When the spinal rod **14** is contacting the saddle **20**, the cap **22** can be moved in the longitudinal direction L until the cap **22** contacts the spinal rod **14**.

(26) The cap **22** can include a single piece, or as shown in the illustrated embodiment, a multiple piece, for example two-pieces. The cap **22** includes threads **38**, for example external threads, that are configured to threadingly engage with threads **40**, for example internal threads, of the anchor body **16**. The cap **22** is rotated in a first direction of rotation about an axis, for example an axis parallel to the longitudinal direction L, such that the threads **38** engage with the threads **40** and the cap **22** moves in the longitudinal direction L with respect to the anchor body **16**. According to one embodiment, the cap **22** is configured to be rotated until the cap **22** is no longer rotatable in the first direction of rotation when a set torque is applied to the cap **22**, thereby securing the spinal rod **14** to the fastener device **12** such that relative movement of the spinal rod **14** and the fastener device **12** is limited, for example prevented, and thereby securing the fastener **18** to the anchor body **16** such that relative movement of the fastener **18** and the anchor body **16** is limited, for example prevented. According to one embodiment, the set torque is between about 2 Newton-meters (N-m) and about 3 N-m.

(27) Referring to FIGS. 3 to 5, the head **32** of the fastener **18** includes an outer surface **42**. According to one aspect of the disclosure, a portion **44** of the outer surface **42** may be convex, may define a portion of a first sphere S1, or both. The first sphere S1 defines a first diameter D1. According to one aspect of the disclosure, the first diameter D1 may be greater than about 4.5 mm. According to another aspect of the disclosure, the first diameter D1 may be greater than about 5.0 mm. According to another aspect of the disclosure, the first diameter D1 may be in a range between about 5.0 mm and about 8.0 mm. According to another aspect of the disclosure, the first diameter D1 may be about 6.0 mm.

(28) The outer surface **42** may include one or more additional portions that do not define a portion of the first sphere S1. As shown in the illustrated embodiment, the outer surface **42** may include a distal portion **46** that is positioned in the distal direction D with respect to the portion **44**, a proximal portion **48** that is positioned in a proximal direction P, which is opposite the distal direction D, with respect to the portion **44**, or both the distal portion **46** and the proximal portion **48**. According to another aspect of the disclosure, an entirety of the outer surface **42** may include the portion **44**, such that the outer surface **42** is devoid of the distal portion **46** and the proximal portion **48**.

(29) The head **32** of the fastener **18** may define a location **50** such that the fastener **18** is devoid of any locations positioned in the proximal direction P from the location **50**. As shown in the illustrated embodiment, the head **32** includes an upper surface **52** that defines a drive mechanism **54**, the drive mechanism **54** configured to receive a driving force that rotates the fastener **18** to secure the fastener **18** to a vertebra. According to one aspect of the disclosure, the upper surface **52** can be substantially flat, such that any point on the upper surface **52** can define the location **50**. According to another aspect of the disclosure, the upper surface **52** can be not flat, for example curved such that an apex of the upper surface **52** defines the location **50**.

(30) According to one aspect of the disclosure, the fastener **18** may include a surface **56** that extends along both the head **32** and the neck **36**. As shown in the illustrated embodiment, the surface **56** may be concave such that the surface **56** defines a radius of curvature R . According to one embodiment, the radius of curvature R may be constant along an entirety of the surface **56**. For example, the surface **56** may define a radius of curvature R of between about 0.25 mm and about 2.0 mm. According to another example, the surface **56** may define a radius of curvature R of between about 0.4 mm and about 1.0 mm. According to another embodiment, the radius of curvature R may vary along the surface **56**. According to another embodiment, the surface **56** may include two perpendicular surfaces such that the surface **56** does not define a radius of curvature R .

(31) The portion of the fastener **18** between the head **32** and the shaft **34**, for example the neck **36**, is a potential area where the fastener **18** may fail under load. According to one aspect of the disclosure, radius of curvature R of the concave surface **56**, may distribute stresses within the fastener **18**, thereby increasing the effective strength of the fastener **18**. For example, a first fastener **18** that defines a first radius of curvature R that is larger than a second radius of curvature defined by a second fastener **18** may result in a better distribution of stresses under load in the first fastener **18** when compared to the second fastener **18**, and thus the first fastener **18** may have an increased effective strength compared to the second fastener **18**.

(32) According to one aspect of the disclosure, the neck **36** defines a second diameter $D2$ that may be measured both in a direction perpendicular to the distal direction D and at a location **57** that is in the distal direction D with respect to the surface **56**. As shown in the illustrated embodiment, the second diameter $D2$ may be measured both in the distal direction D and at the location **57** which is in the distal direction D with respect to an entirety of the surface **56** which defines the radius of curvature R . The second diameter $D2$ may be constant such that the second diameter $D2$ at first and second locations spaced apart with respect to the distal direction D , is the same. Alternatively, the second diameter $D2$ may vary, for example decrease in the distal direction $D2$.

(33) According to another aspect of the disclosure, the second diameter $D2$ may be in a range between about 1.0 mm and about 4.0 mm. According to another aspect of the disclosure, the second diameter $D2$ may be about 2.5 mm. The fastener **18** defines a ratio of the first diameter $D1$ to the second diameter $D2$. According to one aspect of the disclosure, the ratio of the first diameter $D1$ to the second diameter $D2$ is in a range between about 2 to 1 and about 3 to 1.

(34) The fastener **18** may be elongate along an axis, for example a central fastener axis **58**. As shown in the illustrated embodiment, the central fastener axis **58** is parallel to the distal direction D . According to one aspect of the disclosure, the portion **44** of the outer surface **42** may include a first point **60** that is located in the distal direction with respect to all other points of the portion **44** of the outer surface **42**, the surface **56** includes a second point **62** that is located in the proximal direction P with respect to all other points of the surface **56**, the first point **60** is spaced from the central fastener axis **58** a first distance $L1$ measured in a direction perpendicular to the distal direction D , the second point **62** is spaced from the central fastener axis **58** a second distance $L2$ measured in a direction perpendicular to the distal direction D , and the first distance $L1$ is greater than the second distance $L2$.

(35) The head **32** may include an intermediate surface **64** that extends between the surface **56** and the outer surface **42**. According to one aspect of the disclosure, at least a portion of the intermediate surface **64** may be substantially flat and perpendicular to the distal direction D .

(36) The fastener **18** may be configured such that all lines that both lie entirely within a plane $P1$ that is parallel to the distal direction D and that are tangent to the portion **44** of the outer surface **42** are noncollinear with all lines that both lie entirely within the plane $P1$ and that are tangent to the surface **56**. For example, a line **66** which both lies entirely within the plane $P1$ and is tangent to the portion **44** is not collinear with a line **68** which both lies entirely within the plane $P1$ and is tangent to the surface **56**.

(37) Referring to FIGS. **6** and **7**, the anchor body **16** may define a rod-receiving channel **69** that is

configured to receive a spinal rod, for example the spinal rod **14** (as shown in FIG. **1**). The rod-receiving channel **69** extends through the anchor body housing **28** and may be oriented such that the rod-receiving channel **69** is offset from, for example perpendicular to, the through hole **30**. As shown in the illustrated embodiment, the rod-receiving channel **69** may be a U-shaped channel.

(38) The anchor body **16** may further include an inner surface **70** that defines at least a portion of the through hole **30**. According to one aspect of the disclosure, a portion **72** of the inner surface **70** may be concave, may define a portion of a second sphere **S2**, or both. The second sphere **S2** defines a third diameter **D3**. According to one aspect of the disclosure, the third diameter **D3** is equal to the first diameter **D1**. According to another aspect of the disclosure, the third diameter **D3** is either greater than or less than the first diameter **D1**.

(39) The inner surface **70** defines a minimum inner diameter **D4** that is measured both in a direction perpendicular to the longitudinal direction **L** and at a location **74** that is closer to the lower end **26** as measured along the longitudinal direction **L** than the location **74** is to the upper end **24** as measured along the longitudinal direction **L**. As shown in the illustrated embodiment, the location **74** may be spaced a distance from the lower end **26** measured along the longitudinal direction **L**, such that the inner surface **70** tapers radially outward with respect to a central anchor body axis **76** as the inner surface **70** extends from the location **74** to the lower end **26**. According to another aspect of the disclosure, the location **74** may be located at the lower end **26**. According to one embodiment, the location **74** may be positioned on the portion **72** such that no point on the portion **72** is positioned in the longitudinal direction **L** with respect to the location **74**.

(40) The anchor body **16** defines an inner diameter **D5** that is greater than the minimum inner diameter **D4**. According to one aspect of the disclosure, the inner diameter **D5** may be defined by the inner surface **70** at a location that is spaced from the portion **72** in a direction opposite the longitudinal direction **L**. According to another aspect of the disclosure, the inner diameter **D5** may be defined by the upper end **24**. According to one aspect of the disclosure, the inner diameter **D5** may be a maximum inner diameter of the anchor body **16**.

(41) According to one aspect of the disclosure, the upper end **24** defines an upper opening **78** where the through hole **30** exits the anchor body housing **28** in the direction opposite the longitudinal direction **L**, the lower end **26** defines a lower opening **80** where the through hole **30** exits the anchor body housing **28** in the longitudinal direction **L**, or both. As shown in the illustrated embodiment, the anchor body **16** may define a plane **P2** (shown as a line which extends into and out of the page). The plane **P2** may include an entirety of the lower opening **80**, may be perpendicular to the longitudinal direction **L**, or both.

(42) Referring to FIGS. **8** and **9**, the fastener device **12** defines an assembled configuration in which the portion **44** of the outer surface **42** rides along (contacts at more than one point) the portion **72** of the inner surface **70** such that the fastener **18** is movable with respect to the anchor body **16**. The contact between the portion **44** and the portion **72** may define a circle, a portion of a circle, a portion of a sphere, or any combination thereof. According to one aspect of the disclosure, the fastener **18** is movable polyaxially with respect to the anchor body **16** such that the fastener device **12** defines a cone of angulation that includes all of the angles at which the central fastener axis **58** and the central anchor body axis **76** can be offset from one another when the fastener device **12** is in the assembled configuration. The cone of angulation may be defined by a maximum angle α (alpha), for example the cone of angulation may be twice the maximum angle α (alpha).

(43) The maximum angle α (alpha) is measured between the central fastener axis **58** and the central anchor body axis **76** when the anchor body **16** abuts the neck **36** at a location that is spaced in the distal direction **D** from an entirety of the surface **56** such that movement of the fastener **18** relative to the anchor body **16** in at least one direction is blocked. According to one aspect of the disclosure the maximum angle α (alpha) is greater than about 45 degrees. According to another aspect of the disclosure the maximum angle α (alpha) is greater than about 50 degrees. According to another aspect of the disclosure the maximum angle α (alpha) is between about 50 degrees and about 60

degrees. For example, the fastener device **12** may be configured as a cervical fastener device with a maximum angle α (alpha) of about 50 degrees. As another example the fastener device **12** may be configured as a lumbar fastener device with a maximum angle α (alpha) of about 30 degrees.

(44) As shown in FIG. **8**, when the fastener device **12** is in the configuration the central fastener axis **58** and the central anchor body axis **76** may be parallel, for example collinear. As shown in FIG. **9**, when the fastener device **12** is in the configuration the central fastener axis **58** and the central anchor body axis **76** may be angularly offset, for example by the maximum angle α (alpha) or by any angle less than maximum angle α (alpha).

(45) Referring to FIGS. **5**, **7**, and **8**, because the first diameter **D1** is larger than the minimum inner diameter **D4** the head **32** of the fastener **18** is not able to be inserted into the through hole **30** along the direction opposite the longitudinal direction **L** such that the portion **44** of the outer surface **42** rides along the portion **72** of the inner surface **70**. Instead, because the inner diameter **D5** is greater than the first diameter **D1**, the fastener **18** is configured to be inserted into the through hole **30** along the longitudinal direction **L** such that the portion **44** of the outer surface **42** rides along the portion **72** of the inner surface **70**. Thus the fastener device **12** can be described as a top-loading fastener device as opposed to a bottom-loading (or pop-on) fastener device. The fastener device **12** being configured as a top-loading fastener device allows the size of the first diameter **D1** and the size of the second diameter **D2** to remain larger than in a comparable bottom-loading screw, which can result in a fastener device **12**, and specifically a fastener **18**, with increased strength.

(46) Referring to FIG. **9**, according to one aspect of the disclosure the fastener device **12** defines a configuration in which the location **50** is positioned a third distance **L3** from the upper end **24** measured along the longitudinal direction **L**, the lower end **26** is positioned a fourth distance **L4** from the upper end **24** measured along the longitudinal direction **L**, and the third distance **L3** is greater than the fourth distance **L4**. According to one aspect of the disclosure the fastener device **12** defines a configuration in which the location **50** is spaced in the longitudinal direction **L** with respect to the plane **P2**.

(47) According to one aspect of the disclosure, the fastener device **12** defines a configuration (referred to herein as a maximum angled configuration) in which both the portion **44** of the outer surface **42** rides along the portion **72** of the inner surface **70**, and the anchor body **16** abuts the neck **36** at the location **57** that is spaced in the distal direction **D** from an entirety of the surface **56** such that movement of the fastener **18** relative to the anchor body **16** in at least one direction is blocked.

(48) Referring to FIGS. **8** and **9**, the fastener device **12** is illustrated with the saddle **20** abutting the fastener **18**, and the spinal rod **14** and the cap **22** are not shown. The description of FIGS. **8** and **9** applies to the fastener device **12** with and without any combination of the saddle **20**, the cap **22**, and the spinal rod **14**.

(49) As shown in the illustrated embodiment, when the fastener device **12** is in the maximum angled configuration a gap **84** is defined between the surface **56** and the anchor body **16**. The gap **84** is enclosed in both the longitudinal direction **L** and the direction opposite the longitudinal direction **L**. According to one aspect of the disclosure, when the fastener device is in the maximum angled configuration, a region of contact that includes all of the points of contact between the anchor body **16** and the fastener **18** as measured in a plane that is perpendicular to the longitudinal direction **L** defines a portion of a circle that is less than a full circle.

(50) Referring to FIGS. **4** and **9**, according to one aspect of the disclosure the strength of the fastener **18** may be increased by maximizing the second diameter **D2**. However, increasing the size of the second diameter **D2** while not changing other dimensions of the fastener **18**, for example the first diameter **D1**, may result in a fastener device **12** with a lower maximum angle α (alpha). Accordingly, maximizing the second diameter **D2** while maintaining the ratio of the first diameter **D1** to the second diameter **D2** may result in a fastener **18** with increased strength and a fastener device **12** with a greater maximum angle α (alpha). According to one aspect of the disclosure the strength of the fastener **18** may be increased by increasing the size of the radius of curvature **R**. The

increased size of the radius of curvature R may result in less material being present in the area between the head **32** and the threaded shaft **34**, however the large radius of curvature may reduce stress concentrations within the area between the head **32** and the threaded shaft **34**, thereby resulting in increased strength of the fastener **18**.

(51) Additionally, in the fastener device **12** as shown in the illustrated embodiment the portion **44** of the outer surface **42** articulates along or rides along the portion **72** of the inner surface **70** such that the portion **44** directly contacts the portion **72**. According to the illustrated embodiment, the fastener device may be devoid of a collet or other intermediate structure between the portion **44** and the portion **72**. The inclusion of a collet or other intermediate structure positioned within the through hole **30** of a given size would result in the use of a fastener with a first diameter D1 being smaller than the first diameter D1 of the fastener **18** which is configured for use with the fastener device **12** that is devoid of a collet or other intermediate structure. Thus, the fastener device **12** being devoid of a collet or other intermediate structure between the portion **44** and the portion **72** may result in increased strength in the fastener **18** configured for use with the fastener device **12**.

(52) Referring to FIGS. **1** to **9**, a method of making the fastener device **12** may include the step of inserting the fastener **18** into the anchor body **16** such that the threaded shaft **34** passes through the lower opening **80** of the anchor body **16**. The method of making the fastener device **12** may further include the steps of: inserting the saddle **20** into the anchor body **16**; inserting the spinal rod **14** into the anchor body **16**; inserting the cap **22** into the anchor body **16**; or any combination thereof.

(53) The method of making the fastener device **12** may further include the step of tightening the cap **22**. According to one aspect of the disclosure, the fastener device **12** is configured such that after the step of inserting the fastener **18** into the anchor body **16**, and before the tightening step the fastener **18** is freely movable within the through hole **30** with respect to the anchor body **16**, and vice versa. The fastener **18** being freely movable includes the fastener **18** being translatable with respect to the anchor body **16** along the longitudinal direction L, the fastener **18** being polyaxially rotatable with respect to the anchor body **16**, or both.

(54) Referring to FIGS. **10** and **11**, the fastener **18** being freely movable within the through hole **30** with respect to the anchor body **16** may result in undesired movement of the anchor body **16** relative to the fastener **18** during insertion of the fastener **18** into hole **30**. As shown in the illustrated embodiment of FIG. **10**, during insertion, the fastener **18** and the anchor body **16** may be offset with respect to the longitudinal direction L, for example the central fastener axis **58** and the central anchor body axis **76** may be angularly offset by an angle, β (beta). The angular offset of the central fastener axis **58** and the central anchor body axis **76** may result in a force, such as the force of gravity on the anchor body **16**, being sufficient to move the anchor body **16** relative to the fastener **18**, for example until the neck **36** of the fastener **18** contacts the anchor body **16**, as shown in FIG. **11**.

(55) Referring to FIGS. **12** to **17**, the fastener device **12** may include a biasing member **102** configured to restrict, for example by providing a force, relative movement of the anchor body **16** and the fastener **18** after the fastener **18** is inserted into the anchor body **16**, and before the cap **22** is inserted into the through hole **30** such that the cap **22** abuts the spinal rod **14**.

(56) Biasing member **102** may be disposed in a recess **106** in anchor body **16** such that movement of the biasing member **102** relative to the anchor body **16** is limited in a direction, for example a direction parallel to the central anchor body axis **76**. The biasing member **102** may further be configured to provide a force on the outer surface **42** of the fastener **18**. As shown in the illustrated embodiment, the biasing member **102** may be a split ring. According to another embodiment, the biasing member **102** may be a non-circular shape, such as but not limited to a polygonal shape. As shown in the illustrated embodiment, the recess **106** may be defined by the anchor body **16**.

(57) According to one aspect of the disclosure, the biasing member **102** may be configured to expand radially with respect to the central anchor body axis **76**. For example, before the fastener **18** is inserted into the through hole **30**, the biasing member **102** defines an inner diameter D6 having a

first dimension. The biasing member **102** may be configured to expand as the fastener **18** is inserted into the through hole **30**, and the outer surface **42** of the fastener contacts the biasing member **102**. Once the fastener **18** is fully seated within the through hole **30**, such that no further movement of the fastener **18** in the longitudinal direction L relative to the anchor body **18**, is possible due to the outer surface **42** abutting the inner surface **70**, the inner diameter D6 has a second dimension that is larger than the first dimension. The biasing member **102** is configured such that increasing the size of the inner diameter D6 imparts a force on the outer surface **44** of the fastener **18**. According to one aspect of the disclosure, the fastener device **12** is configured such that the biasing member **102** imparts the force on the outer surface **42** in a direction substantially perpendicular to the central anchor body axis **76**.

(58) Referring to FIG. **13**, the biasing member **102** includes an inner surface **112** and an outer surface **114**. As shown in the illustrated embodiment, the inner surface **112** defines a through hole **115** that extends through the biasing member **100**. The inner surface **112** may define at least a portion, for example greater than half of, a circle. The circle of which at least a portion is defined by the inner surface **112** may include a center **116**. The inner diameter D6 is measured along a straight line from a first point on the inner surface **112**, through the center **116**, to a second point on the inner surface **112** spaced apart from the first point.

(59) The biasing member **102** may further define an outer diameter D7 measured along a straight line from a first point on the outer surface **114**, through the center **116**, to a second point on the outer surface **114** spaced apart from the first point on the outer surface **114**. The outer diameter D7 is greater than the inner diameter D6.

(60) Referring to FIG. **14**, the inner surface **70** of the anchor body **16** defines the recess **106**. The recess **106** extends radially into the inner surface **70** of the anchor body **16** and terminates at a base surface **118**. The recess **106** further extends into the inner surface **70** of the anchor body **16** such that the recess **106** defines a recess height RH. The recess height RH is measured along a straight line that is parallel to the central anchor body axis **76** from a recess upper surface **120** to a recess lower surface **122**. The anchor body **16** defines an inner diameter D8 measured along a straight line that is perpendicular to the central anchor body axis **76** from a first point on the base surface **118**, through the central anchor body axis **76**, to a second point on the base surface **118** that is spaced from the first point.

(61) The anchor body **16** further defines an inner diameter D9 measured along a straight line that is perpendicular to the central anchor body axis **76** from a first point on the inner surface **70** that is offset from the recess in the direction opposite the longitudinal direction L, through the central anchor body axis **76**, to a second point on the inner surface **70** that is spaced from the first point. The anchor body **16** further defines an inner diameter D10 measured along a straight line that is perpendicular to the central anchor body axis **76** from a first point on a portion **86** of the inner surface **70** that is offset from the recess in the longitudinal direction L, through the central anchor body axis **76**, to a second point on the portion **86** of the inner surface **70** that is spaced from the first point. According to one aspect of the disclosure, the inner diameter D8 is larger than both the inner diameter D9 and the inner diameter D10. As shown in the illustrated embodiment, the portion **86** may be curved and define a portion of a sphere having a diameter.

(62) Referring to FIGS. **12** to **15**, the biasing member **102** includes an unbiased state when the fastener **18** is not abutting the inner surface **112** and the anchor body **16** is not abutting the outer surface **114**. The biasing member **102** further includes a biased state when the fastener **18** is abutting the inner surface **112**, the anchor body **16** is abutting the outer surface **114**, or both. The fastener device **12** may be configured such that the biasing member **102** is configured to be positioned within the recess **106**. According to one aspect of the disclosure, the biasing member **102** is configured to be in the unbiased state when positioned within the recess **106**, and the recess **106** is configured to retain the biasing member **102** within the recess **106**, as shown in FIG. **15**.

(63) As shown in the illustrated embodiment, the fastener device **12** may be configured such that,

in the unbiased state, the inner diameter D6 is smaller than both the inner diameter D9 and the inner diameter D10, the outer diameter D7 is larger than both the inner diameter D9 and the inner diameter D10, and the inner diameter D8 is larger than the outer diameter D7. The biasing member 102, in the unbiased state, is disposed within the recess 106 such that movement of the biasing member 102 out of the recess along the longitudinal direction L is blocked by the upper surface 120 and the lower surface 122. The recess 106 further provides room for the biasing member 102 to expand radially out toward the base surface 118.

(64) The biasing member 102 may further include a top surface 130 and a bottom surface 132 opposite the top surface 130. As shown in the illustrated embodiment, the bottom surface 132 faces in the longitudinal direction L and the top surface 130 faces in the direction opposite the longitudinal direction L. The biasing member 102 may further include one or more tapered surfaces 134. The one or more tapered surfaces 134 may include a first tapered surface 134' that extends between the upper surface 130 and the inner surface 112, a second tapered surface 134'' that extends between the lower surface 132 and the inner surface 112, or both. The one or more tapered surfaces 134 may be linear, curved, or partially linear and partially curved. The one or more tapered surfaces 134 are configured to enable easier entry of the fastener 18 into the through hole 115, for example by lowering the amount of force required compared to a biasing member 102 devoid of the one or more tapered surfaces 134.

(65) Referring to FIG. 16, the fastener 18 is configured to be inserted into the through hole 30 such that the threaded shaft 34 extends through the lower opening 80 and the outer surface 42 abuts the inner surface 112, thereby transitioning the biasing member 102 into a biased state. The fastener device 12 may define a fully seated configuration in which the outer surface 42 abuts the portion 86 of the inner surface 70. When the fastener device 12 is in the fully seated configuration the biasing member 102 exerts a force on the fastener 18, and that force resists relative to movement of the fastener 18 and the anchor body 16.

(66) Relative movement of the fastener 18 and the anchor body 16 along the longitudinal direction L is resisted by the biasing member 102, which is exerting an inward radial force on the fastener 18, abutting either the upper surface 120 or the lower surface 122. Relative rotation, for example polyaxial rotation, of the fastener 18 and the anchor body 16 is resisted by a drag force or friction force resulting from the inward radial force exerted by the biasing member 102 on the fastener 18.

(67) According to one aspect of the disclosure, the fastener 18 defines a widest location 136 that is larger, as measured along a straight line perpendicular to the central fastener axis 58 from a first point on the outer surface 42, through the central fastener axis 58, to a second point on the outer surface 42, than any other location on the head 32. The fastener device 12 may be configured such that in the fully seated configuration, when the central fastener axis 58 is parallel to the central anchor body axis 76, the biasing member 102 abuts the outer surface 42 at a location aligned with the widest location 136 with respect to the distal direction D.

(68) According to another embodiment, the fastener device 12 may be configured such that in the fully seated configuration, when the central fastener axis 58 is parallel to the central anchor body axis 76, the biasing member 102 abuts the outer surface 42 at a location either spaced from the widest location 136 in the distal direction D, or spaced from the widest location 136 in the proximal direction P.

(69) The method of making the fastener device 12 may include the step of inserting the fastener 18 into the biasing member 102 until the outer surface 42 abuts the portion 86 of the inner surface 70. The above step of inserting the fastener 18 into the biasing member 102 may include the step of radially expanding the biasing member 102 such that the inner diameter D6 increases. The above step of inserting the fastener 18 into the biasing member 102 may further include, after the step of radially expanding the biasing member 102, the step of radially contracting the biasing member 102 such that the inner diameter D6 decreases.

(70) Referring to FIG. 17, the biasing member 102 is configured to resist undesired relative

movement of the fastener **18** and the anchor body **16**, but allow desired relative movement of the fastener **18** and the anchor body **16**. In use, when the fastener **18** is in the fully seated configuration, the anchor body **16** may be moved relative to the fastener **18**, for example by a surgeon manipulating at least one of the fastener **18** and the anchor body **16**. Additionally, when the fastener **18** is in the fully seated configuration, the biasing member **102** prevents relative movement of the anchor body **16** relative to the fastener **18**, for example due to gravity acting on the anchor body **16** when the central fastener axis **58** is angular offset from the central anchor body axis **76** by the angle β (beta). According to one aspect of the disclosure, the angle β (beta) may be between 0 and the maximum angle α (alpha).

(71) The description of the biasing member **102** illustrated in FIGS. **12** to **17** also applies to the embodiments illustrated in FIGS. **1** to **11**. Additionally, the description of the embodiments illustrated in FIGS. **1** to **11** is applicable to the embodiments illustrated in FIGS. **12** to **17**.

(72) It will be appreciated that the foregoing description provides examples of the disclosed system and technique. However, it is contemplated that other implementations of the disclosure may differ in detail from the foregoing examples. All references to the disclosure or examples thereof are intended to reference the particular example being discussed at that point and are not intended to imply any limitation as to the scope of the disclosure more generally. All language of distinction and disparagement with respect to certain features is intended to indicate a lack of preference for those features, but not to exclude such from the scope of the disclosure entirely unless otherwise indicated.

(73) Recitation of ranges of values herein are merely intended to serve as a shorthand method of referring individually to each separate value falling within the range including the stated ends of the range, unless otherwise indicated herein, and each separate value is incorporated into the specification as if it were individually recited herein. All methods described herein can be performed in any suitable order unless otherwise indicated herein or otherwise clearly contradicted by context.

(74) Although the disclosure has been described in detail, it should be understood that various changes, substitutions, and alterations can be made herein without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention as defined by the appended claims. Moreover, the scope of the present disclosure is not intended to be limited to the particular embodiments described in the specification. As one of ordinary skill in the art will readily appreciate from the disclosure of the present invention, processes, machines, manufacture, composition of matter, means, methods, or steps, presently existing or later to be developed that perform substantially the same function or achieve substantially the same result as the corresponding embodiments described herein may be utilized according to the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A fastener device configured to secure a spinal rod relative to a bone, the fastener device comprising: an anchor body including an anchor body housing, the anchor body defining a through hole that extends through the anchor body housing, the anchor body further defining a rod-receiving channel that is configured to receive the spinal rod and that is offset with respect to the through hole, the anchor body further including an upper end, a lower end, and an inner surface, the inner surface defining a least a portion of the through hole; and a fastener including a head, a threaded shaft that extends out with respect to the head in a distal direction, and a neck that extends between the head and the threaded shaft, the head including an outer surface configured to articulate relative to the inner surface when the head is inserted in the through hole, at least a portion of the outer surface being convex and defining a portion of a sphere, the sphere defining a first diameter, and the fastener including a concave surface that extends along both the head and the neck, the neck defining a second diameter measured: 1) in a direction perpendicular to the distal

direction, and 2) at a location spaced in the distal direction of an entirety of the concave surface, wherein the fastener defines a ratio of the first diameter to the second diameter in a range between about 2 to 1 and about 3 to 1.

2. The fastener device of claim 1, wherein: the fastener is elongate along a central axis that is parallel to the distal direction; the portion of the outer surface includes a first point that is located in the distal direction with respect to all other points of the portion of the outer surface; the concave surface includes a second point that is located in a proximal direction, which is opposite the distal direction, with respect to all other points of the concave surface; and the first point is spaced from the central axis a first distance measured in a direction perpendicular to the distal direction, the second point is spaced from the central axis a second distance measured in a direction perpendicular to the distal direction, and the first distance is greater than the second distance.

3. The fastener device of claim 1, wherein the location is a first location, the through hole extends away from the upper end and toward the lower end in a longitudinal direction, and the inner surface defines a minimum inner diameter that is both: 1) measured at a second location that is on the inner surface, and 2) measured in a direction perpendicular to the longitudinal direction, the second location is closer to the lower end as measured along the longitudinal direction, than the second location is to the upper end as measured along the longitudinal direction.

4. The fastener device of claim 3, wherein the lower end defines a lower opening where the through hole exits the anchor body housing, the anchor body defines a plane that includes an entirety of the lower opening, the head of the fastener defines a third location such that the fastener is devoid of any locations positioned in a proximal direction, which is opposite the distal direction, from the third location, and the fastener device defines a configuration in which the third location is positioned a first distance from the upper end, the lower end is positioned a second distance from the upper end, the first distance and the second distance each measured along the longitudinal direction, and the first distance is greater than the second distance.

5. The fastener device of claim 3, wherein the first diameter is larger than the minimum inner diameter.

6. The fastener device of claim 5, wherein the upper end defines an upper opening where the through hole exits the anchor body housing, the upper opening defines an inner diameter measured in the direction perpendicular to the longitudinal direction, and the inner diameter is greater than both the first diameter and the minimum inner diameter.

7. The fastener device of claim 1, wherein all lines that: 1) lie entirely within a plane parallel to the distal direction, and 2) are tangent to the portion of the outer surface are noncollinear with all lines that: 1) lie entirely within the plane, and 2) are tangent to the concave surface.

8. The fastener device of claim 1, further comprising a stabilization mechanism configured to be positioned in the through hole such that when the fastener is inserted in the through hole such that the outer surface contacts the inner surface the stabilization mechanism exerts a force on the fastener that resists relative movement of the fastener and the anchor body.

9. The fastener device of claim 8, wherein the stabilization mechanism includes a biasing member configured to expand as the head of the fastener contacts the biasing member, such that the expanded biasing member exerts the force on the outer surface of the fastener.

10. The fastener device of claim 9, wherein the anchor body defines a recess configured to receive the biasing member such that the biasing member is captured within the recess.

11. The fastener device of claim 1, wherein the inner surface defines a recess is configured to face radially inwardly toward a widest portion of the head of the fastener as measured along a second direction that is perpendicular to the first direction.

12. The fastener device of claim 11, wherein the widest portion of the head forms a portion of the outer surface and an entirety of the widest portion of the head is configured to be radially aligned with the recess when the widest portion of the head defines a plane that is perpendicular to the first direction.

13. A fastener device configured to secure a spinal rod relative to a bone, the fastener device comprising: an anchor body including an anchor body housing and a central axis, the anchor body defining a through hole that extends through the anchor body housing along the central axis, the anchor body further defining a rod-receiving channel that is configured to receive the spinal rod, the anchor body further including an upper end, a lower end spaced from the upper end in a first direction, and an inner surface that defines at least a portion of the through hole, the inner surface including: 1) a first portion that has a first cross-sectional dimension, 2) a second portion that defines a second cross-sectional dimension that is equal to or greater than the first cross-sectional dimension, and 3) a third portion that defines a recess that defines a third cross-sectional dimension that is greater than both the first cross-sectional dimension and the second cross-sectional dimension, wherein the first portion terminates at a first end of the recess in a direction that is opposite the first direction, and the third portion is disposed between the first portion and the second portion with respect to the first direction; and a fastener including a head and a threaded shaft that extends out with respect to the head, the head including an outer surface configured to articulate relative to the first portion of the inner surface when the head is inserted in the through hole, wherein a part of the outer surface of the head is configured to be disposed beyond the first end of the recess along the direction that is opposite the first direction when the head is inserted in the through hole, wherein the recess is configured to face radially inwardly toward a widest portion of the head of the fastener as measured along a second direction that is perpendicular to the first direction, the widest portion of the head forms a portion of the outer surface, and an entirety of the widest portion of the head is configured to be radially aligned with the recess when the widest portion of the head defines a plane that is perpendicular to the first direction.

14. The fastener device of claim 13, further comprising a biasing member configured to be inserted into the through hole and positioned such that the biasing member is aligned with the third portion along a second direction that is perpendicular to the first direction.

15. The fastener device of claim 14, wherein the biasing member is a split ring that includes an inner surface that faces the central axis when the split ring is inserted in the through hole, the split ring defines a fourth cross-sectional dimension measured from a first point on the inner surface, through the central axis, to a second point on the inner surface in the second direction, and when the split ring is in an unbiased state the fourth cross-sectional dimension is less than each of the first cross-sectional dimension, the second cross-sectional dimension, and the third cross-sectional dimension.

16. The fastener device of claim 14, wherein the biasing member is configured to contact the outer surface of the head of the fastener.

17. The fastener device of claim 13, wherein the first portion defines a portion of a first sphere that has the first cross-sectional dimension, the threaded shaft extends out with respect to the head in a distal direction, the fastener includes a neck that extends between the head and the threaded shaft, at least a portion of the outer surface is convex and defines a portion of a second sphere, the second sphere defining a first fastener diameter, the fastener includes a concave surface that extends along both the head and the neck, the neck defines a second fastener diameter measured: 1) in a direction perpendicular to the distal direction, and 2) at a location spaced in the distal direction of an entirety of the concave surface, and the fastener defines a ratio of the first fastener diameter to the second fastener diameter in a range between about 2 to 1 and about 3 to 1.

18. The fastener device of claim 17, wherein: the fastener is elongate along a central axis that is parallel to the distal direction; the portion of the outer surface includes a first point that is located in the distal direction with respect to all other points of the portion of the outer surface; the concave surface includes a second point that is located in a proximal direction which is opposite the distal direction, with respect to all other points of the concave surface; and the first point is spaced from the central axis a first distance measured in a direction perpendicular to the distal direction, the second point is spaced from the central axis a second distance measured in a direction

perpendicular to the distal direction, and the first distance is greater than the second distance.

19. The fastener device of claim 18, wherein the location is a first location, the through hole extends away from the upper end and toward the lower end in a longitudinal direction, and the inner surface defines a minimum inner diameter that is both: 1) measured at a second location that is on the inner surface, and 2) measured in a direction perpendicular to the longitudinal direction, the second location is closer to the lower end as measured along the longitudinal direction, than the second location is to the upper end as measured along the longitudinal direction.

20. The fastener device of claim 13, wherein the recess faces toward the head of the fastener when the fastener is in a first configuration in which the outer surface is in contact with a portion of a sphere defined by the first portion.
